

22 Using "a" and "the"

Use the definite article ("the") or indefinite article ("a," "an") to talk about things in specific or general terms. Use "some" to talk about more than one thing.

 **New language** Definite and indefinite articles

Aa Vocabulary Places in town

 **New skill** Using articles

22.1 KEY LANGUAGE "A / AN / THE"

Use "a" to talk about a thing in general. Use "the" to talk about a place, person, or thing that you and the listener both know about.



I work in **a** library.

Use "a" because you are talking about your work in general, not the specific place where you work.



I work in **the** library on Main Street.

Use "the" because you are talking about the specific building where you work.



22.2 FURTHER EXAMPLES "A / AN / THE"



Jim is **an** artist.

Use "a / an" to talk about jobs.

Use "an" before words that start with a vowel.



The doctor at my hospital is good.

Use "the" to talk about a particular doctor.



Is there **a** bank near here?

Use "a" with "is there" and "there is."



I go to **the** bank on Broad Street.

Use "the" to talk about a particular bank.



22.3 CROSS OUT THE INCORRECT WORDS IN EACH SENTENCE

Charlotte is ~~a~~ / **an** / ~~the~~ actress.

① **A** / **An** / **The** new teacher is called Miss Jones.

② There is **a** / **an** / **the** good café in the park.

③ I work at **a** / **an** / **the** hotel next to the library.

④ There is **a** / **an** / **the** swimming pool near my office.

⑤ It is **a** / **an** / **the** dog's favorite toy.

⑥ Janie is **a** / **an** / **the** artist at the gallery.

⑦ See you at **a** / **an** / **the** café at the bus station.

